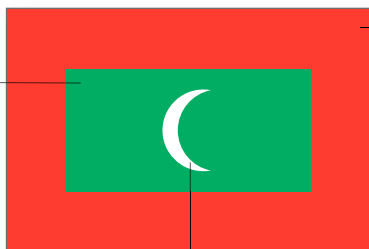


Maldives

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** July 26, 1965 **Usage:** National and Civil

The panel of Islamic green symbolizes peace and prosperity



Red was the original color of the Maldives flag

The crescent represents Islam

Asia



The archipelago of small islands that forms the **Maldives** was once a British Protectorate. The Maldives became fully independent in 1965.

Until the beginning of the 20th century the flag of the Maldives was plain red, reflecting the culture of the Arab traders from the Persian Gulf who operated among the islands. This flag remained in use after the British Protectorate was set up in 1887. The flag later acquired a white crescent facing the hoist—another sign of Islamic influence.

A NEW DESIGN

The flag was redesigned in 1948 after the independence of Ceylon (now Sri Lanka) of which the islands had been a dependency. The crescent was turned around and placed on an Islamic green panel. A pattern of black and white diagonal stripes was

added along the hoist. This was dropped after independence from Britain in 1965. A modern interpretation of the colors suggests that red symbolizes the blood shed in the struggle for independence, while green stands for peace and progress.

THE NATIONAL ARMS

The coat of arms of the Maldives contains the Islamic crescent and star emblem beneath a date palm. Below the crescent is a scroll with the inscription, in Dihevi, “State of a Thousand Islands,” which recalls the many islands—over 2000—that make up the Maldives. The crescent is flanked by two national flags.